



## USB - HARD DRIVES

| lomega                                                           | Transcend                  | Transcend                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------|
| 120 GB                                                           | 20 GB                      | TS40GHDENC                 |
| 184.2 x 114.3 x 34.3                                             | 145 x 80 x 17              | 145 x 80 x 17              |
| 817                                                              | 174                        | 176                        |
| 3.5                                                              | 2.5                        | 2.5                        |
| 120                                                              | 20                         | 40                         |
| 7200                                                             | 4200                       | 4200                       |
| 2                                                                | 2                          | 2                          |
| USB 2.0                                                          | USB 2.0                    | USB 2.0                    |
| Power cum Data transfer                                          | Power and Data Transfer    | Power and Data Transfer    |
| ✗                                                                | ✗                          | ✗                          |
| 3                                                                | 3.5                        | 3.5                        |
| 3.5                                                              | 3.5                        | 3.5                        |
| lomega AutoBackup, Norton Ghost 2003, lomega Fat32 fomatter tool | ✗                          | ✗                          |
| ✗                                                                | ✓                          | ✓                          |
| Power cable, USB 2.0 cable, FireWire cable                       | PS2 Power cable, datacable | PS2 Power cable, datacable |
| ✓                                                                | ✓                          | ✓                          |
| on CD                                                            | on CD                      | on CD                      |
| 22308                                                            | 14118                      | 18796                      |
| 32                                                               | 20                         | 28                         |
| 8                                                                | 4                          | 5                          |
| 26                                                               | 20                         | 26                         |
| 12                                                               | 3.94                       | 6                          |
| 6                                                                | 12                         | 11                         |
| 18.7                                                             | 21.6                       | 19.4                       |
| 25.8                                                             | 17.4                       | 23.5                       |
| 17.3                                                             | 10.5                       | 13                         |
| 33.2                                                             | 34.4                       | 34.5                       |
| 18.3                                                             | 8.4                        | 12.5                       |
| 56.64                                                            | 195.14                     | 39.63                      |
| 53.07                                                            | 61.16                      | 51.83                      |
| 96.66                                                            | 57.1                       | 47.57                      |
| 59.01                                                            | 75.82                      | 60.98                      |
| 0.13                                                             | 0.42                       | 0.29                       |
| 7.90                                                             | 10.10                      | 10.10                      |
| 58.20                                                            | 44.66                      | 57.34                      |
| 66.10                                                            | 54.76                      | 67.44                      |
| 25.95                                                            | 6.52                       | 11.68                      |
| 15,000                                                           | 8,000                      | 11,000                     |

GB model, with an access time of 16 milliseconds. The rest of the drives all logged times from 18 to 20 milliseconds. The random access time helps us gauge the amount of time required for a drive to access and retrieve data from any random location. These drives logged higher access times than the desktop drive because of the USB interface.

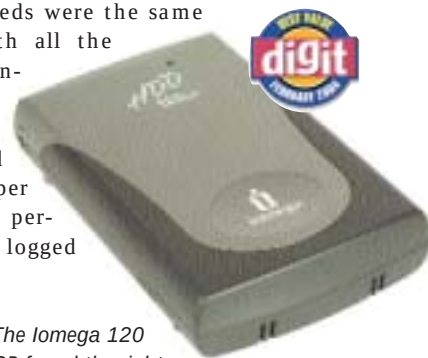
## Not Just Storage

The recent trend of combining different devices into a single base gadget has also extended to the portable storage area. The Apacer Audio Steno BP300 and the Creative Nomad MuVo are two very good examples of this. Essentially, both these devices are solid-state memory-based USB thumb drives, but also slightly modified to function as portable MP3 players. The Apacer Audio Steno also doubles up as a small and handy voice recorder. Both the MP3 players come with earphones, a neck-strap and the AAA battery to power the player.

For hard drive-based mobile storage, the iPod from Apple is easily the most stylish compact gadget. It comes with a 2-inch LCD screen and weighs just 176 grams. It features impressive support for various audio formats, and has a maximum capacity of 30 GB. It can give up to 6 hours of continuous playing time with its internal lithium-ion battery. Its price tag of Rs 45,000 for 30 GB, puts it out of the reach of most people, but that's what one would expect to pay for the funkiest gizmos available today.

The read burst speeds were the same across the board, with all the drives reporting a constant value of 34 MBps. In terms of CPU utilisation, the portable hard drives took the upper hand, with the lowest percentages of 8.4 and 10 logged in by the Transcend 20 GB and the 20 GB Freecom FHD-2 drives, respectively.

**Real-world tests:** Unlike in the synthetic tests, where we saw the larger 7,200-rpm drives winning throughout—except in the CPU utilisation—the real world tests witnessed a more spirited retaliation from the slower 4,200-rpm drives. In the sequential write test, where we copied a 1 GB TIFF image to the test device, and noted the time taken—the lowest time was recorded by the 40 GB FHD-1 drive with a transfer time of 45.41 seconds, followed closely by the Transcend 40 GB drive. However, in the sequential read test, where we copied the same file back to the system hard drive, the Transcend drive finished more than 11 seconds faster than the FHD-1 drive. This implies that if you frequently save and move large files, the Transcend drive will do a better job than the rest.



*The lomega 120 GB found the right mix by bundling great software, providing a huge capacity and an unbeatable price per MB of 13 paise. It won the Best Value award with ease*

## Contact details

| Brand       | Apacer           | Easydisk                   | Freecom        | Nexdisk               | Princeton      | Touchmate             | Transcend                |
|-------------|------------------|----------------------------|----------------|-----------------------|----------------|-----------------------|--------------------------|
| Vendor name | Xserve India Ltd | GNH Systems                | J.S Equipments | Maatra Technologies   | J.S Equipments | Sujata Electronics    | Wales Technologies       |
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